MIL-C-60808A(AR)
10 April 1987
SUPERSEDING
MIL-C-60808
31 May 1967

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

CARTRIDGE, CALIBER .45, REFERENCE

This Specification is approved for use within the US Army Armament Munitions and Chemical Command and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specfication covers a cartridge to be used for calibration purposes in Caliber .45 acceptance testing equipment.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications and standards. The following specifications and standards form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified the issues of these documents shall be those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DoDISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation.

SPECIFICATIONS

MILITARY

MIL-A-48078 - Ammunition, Standard Quality Assurance Provisions General Specification for

STANDARDS

MILITARY.

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspections of Attributes

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Commander, U.S. Army Armament Munitions and Chemical Command, Attn: AMSMC-QA, Picatinny Arsenal, New Jersey 07806-5000 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

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DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

MIL-STD-109 -	Quality Assurance Terms and Definitions
MIL-STD-636 -	Visual Inspection Standards for Small Arms Ammunition Through Caliber .50
MIL-STD-644 -	Visual Inspection Standards for Inspection of Packaging, Packing and Marking of Small Arms Ammunition
MIL-STD-1168-	Lot Numbering of Ammunition

2.1.2 Other Government documents, drawings and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings and publications form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issue shall be those in effect on the date of solicitation.

DRAWINGS

U.S. ARMY ARMAMENT RESEARCH, DEVELOPMENT AND ENGINEERING CENTER (ARDEC)

7643674 -	Classfication of Cartridge Case Defects
9396206 -	Packing and marking for box, wirebound for cartridges, small caliber
10522507 -	Cartridge, Caliber .45, Reference
LI-10522507 -	Index of Inspection Equipment Lists, Cartridge, Caliber .45 Reference

PUBLICATIONS

SCATP-.45 -	Ammuntion Ballistic Acceptance Test Methods, Test Procedures for Caliber .45 Cartridges

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings and publications and other Government documents required by contractors in connection with specified acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting activity.)

2.2 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this specification and references cited herein, (except for associated detail specifications, specification sheets, or MS standards) the text of this specification shall take precedence. Nothing, however, shall supersede applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 General. The cartridge shall comply with drawing 10522507, referenced specifications and the following:

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3.2 Bullet extraction. The force required to extract the bullet from the cartridge shall not be less than 40 pounds.

3.3 Residual stress. The cartridge case shall not split or crack when subjected to one percent mercurous nitrate solution for 15 minutes.

3.4 Waterproof. The cartridge shall not release more than one bubble of air when subjected to a pressure differential of 5 pounds per square inch (psi) for 15 seconds.

3.5 Velocity. The grand average of the velocities of all the sample cartridges, conditioned at 70° Fahrenheit (F), shall be 855 feet per sec (ft/sec), plus or minus 20 ft/sec, at 25.5 feet from the muzzle of the weapon. The average of standard deviations of velocities for fifteen 20-round series shall not exceed 15 ft/sec.

3.6 Chamber pressure. The grand average of the chamber pressure of all the sample cartridges, conditioned at 70°F, shall not exceed 19,000 psi. The average of the standard deviations of chamber pressure for fifteen 20-round series shall not exceed 800 psi.

3.7 Function and casualty. The cartridges shall function without casualty.

3.8 Workmanship. The metal parts of the cartridge shall be free of cracks, splits, perforations, burrs and foreign matter. The cleaning method used shall not be injurious to any part, nor shall the parts be contaminated by any cleaning agent. All parts and assemblies shall be fabricated, loaded and assembled in a thorough and workmanlike manner. In addition, the cartridge shall comply with the standards specified in the caliber .45 section of MIL-STD-636. Extreme care should be exercised to avoid contamination of primers or propellant by oil, grease or other foreign matter.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may utilize his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

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4.1.1 Responsibility for compliance. All items must meet all requirements of sections 3 and 5. The inspection set forth in this specification shall become a part of the contractor's overall inspection system or quality program. The absence of any inspection requirements in the specification shall not relieve the contractor the the responsibility of assuring that all products or supplies submitted to the Government for acceptance comply with all requirements of the contract. Sampling in quality conformance does not authorize submission of known defective material, either indicated or actual, nor does it commit the Government to acceptance of any defective material.

4.1.2 Quality assurance terms and definitions. Reference shall be made to MIL-STD-109 to define quality assurance terms used.

4.2 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classed as follows:

Quality Conformance Inspection (see 4.3)

4.3 Quality Conformance Inspection.

4.3.1 Lot formation. Lot formation shall be in accordance with MIL-A-48078.

4.3.1.1 Lot submission. The product shall be submitted in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The entire lot of reference cartridges shall be assembled and charged on a single loading machine (see 6.7).

4.3.1.2 Component parts. Unless otherwise specified, component lots shall be homogeneous and of a size convenient to the contractor and inspected, tested and accepted by the contractor. The cartridge lot shall contain:

a. Cartridge cases from one unchanged process and one manufacturer.
b. Bullets from one unchanged process and one manufacturer.
c. Primers from one lot and one manufacturer.
d. Propellant from one lot and one manufacturer.

4.3.1.3 Lot identification. Each lot of ammunition shall be identified as to type, caliber and model, as well as a lot number in accordance with MIL-STD-1168.

4.3.2 Examination for defects.

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a. Major and minor defects. Examination for major and minor defects shall be perfromed on a class basis in accordance with Classification of Defects using applicable sampling plans and acceptance criteria of MIL-STD-105. The Acceptance Quality Level (AQL) for the major class shall be 0.25 percent and the AQL for the minor class shall be 1.50 percent unless otherwise specified. All non-conforming cartridges shall be rejected.

b. Critical defects. Unless otherwise specified, one hundred percent examination shall be performed for all critical defects. If a visual critical defect is found in a sample either just prior to a firing test or after a firing test (and defect is not due to firing) the lot shall be rejected. The lot shall then be rescreened and resubmitted for visual inspection of critical defects. If a critical defect is found during packing, the portion of the lot that has been packed or is in the process of being packed shall be rejected. In addition, the portion of the lot remaining to be packed shall be rejected. The lot shall then be rescreened and resubmitted for visual inspection of critical defects.

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QUALITY CONFORMANCE INSEPCTION

CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS

MIL-C-60808A(AR)

PARAGRAPH	TITLE	SHEET	DRAWING NUMBER
4.3.2.1	Cartridge, Caliber .45 Reference	1 OF 3	10522507
			NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY: Not applicable

CATEGORY	EXAMINATION OR TEST 1/	NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS	AQL OR 100%	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	PARAGRAPH REFERENCE 2/ /INSPECTION METHOD
CRITICAL					
1.	Case split in K, L or M location (6)		100%	3.1	Visual
2.	Case split in I or J location with powder loss (6)		100%	3.1	Visual
3.	Perforated case (7)		100%	3.1	Visual
4.	Primer missing (26)		100%	3.1	Visual
5.	Primer cocked (27)		100%	3.1	Visual
6.	Primer inverted (25)		100%	3.1	Visual
MAJOR	(Class AQL - 0.25% except for Major 101)				
101.	Case split in I or J location with no powder loss (6)		100%	3.1	Visual
102.	Corroded or stained cartridge (if etched) case (2)			3.1	Visual
103.	Round head, case (4)			3.1	Visual
104.	Dented case (5)			3.1	Visual
105.	Draw scratch in case (8)			3.1	Visual
106.	Beveled underside of head (10)			3.1	Visual

NOTES: 1/ Numbers after defect descriptions refer to visual defect standards in MIL-STD-636 (caliber .45 section).
2/ Refer to MIL-STD-636 (caliber .45 section) for visual standards. In event of conflict between 4.3.2.1 of this specification and MIL-STD-636 as to defect classification the classification specified in 4.3.2.1 shall apply.

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QUALITY CONFORMANCE INSPECTION

CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS

MIL-C-60808A(AR)

PARAGRAPH	TITLE		SHEET 2 OF 3	DRAWING NUMBER
4.3.2.1	Cartridge, Caliber .45 Reference			10522507
				NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY: Not applicable
CATEGORY	EXAMINATION OR TEST 1/	NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS	AQL OR 100%	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH / PARAGRAPH REFERENCE 2/ /INSPECTION METHOD
107.	Scaly metal on case (11)			3.1 Visual
108.	No chamfer on head (rim) (12)			3.1 Visual
109.	Split bullet jacket (20)			3.1 Visual
110.	Loose bullet (21)			3.1 Visual/Manual
111.	Scaly metal on bullet (22)			3.1 Visual
112.	Loose primer (29)			3.1 Visual/Manual
113.	Total Length			3.1 Gage
114.	Cartridge profile failure (requiring more than 5 lbs dead weight to insert in profile and alignment gage)			3.1 Gage
115.	Diameter of extractor groove, max			3.1 Gage
116.	Diameter of head			3.1 Gage
117.	thickness of head			3.1 Gage
118.	Depth of primer			3.1 Gage
119.	Length of Case			3.1 Gage
MINOR	(Class AQL - 1.5%)			
201.	Discolored, dirty, oily or smeared (waterproofing) (1)			3.1 Visual
202.	Dent in case (5)			3.1 Visual
203.	Draw scratch in case (8)			3.1 Visual
204.	Scratch in case (9)			3.1 Visual
205.	Scaly metal on case (1)			3.1 Visual
206.	No chamfer on head (rim) (12)			3.1 Visual
207.	Wrinkle in case (13)			3.1 Visual

NOTES:

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QUALITY CONFORMANCE INSPECTION

CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS

MIL-C-60808A(AR)

PARAGRAPH	TITLE		SHEET 3 OF 3		DRAWING NUMBER 10522507
4.3.2.1	Cartridge, Caliber .45 Reference				NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY Not applicable
CATEGORY	EXAMINATION OR TEST 1/	NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS	AQL OR 100%	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	PARAGRAPH REFERENCE 2/ /INSPECTION METHOD
208.	Head stamp missing or illegible (15)			3.1	Visual
209.	Defective head (16)			3.1	Visual
210.	Defective mouth (17)			3.1	Visual
211.	Dented bullet (18)			3.1	Visual
212.	Scratch on bullet (19)			3.1	Visual
213.	Scaly metal on bullet (22)			3.1	Visual
214.	Upset (crooked) point (23)			3.1	Visual
215.	Exposed steel (clad jacket) (24)			3.1	Visual
216.	Flat point (25)			3.1	Visual
217.	Nicked or dented primer (30)			3.1	Visual
218.	No waterproofing (primer pocket joint) (31)			3.1	Visual
219.	Diameter of extractor groove, min			3.1	Gage
220.	Poor workmanship 3/			3.12	Visual

NOTES:

3/ Defects other than those listed in MIL-STD-636 (caliber .45 section).

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4.3.3 Testing. Testing is described in the Quality Conformance Inspection tables (4.3.3.1). Testing shall be conducted in accordance with the methods and procedures specified in 4.4.

a. Test samples. The quantities for the various tests shall be as specified in 4.3.3.1. Only cartridges having met the visual and dimensional requirements shall be used in the ballistic tests, and shall have been selected in such a manner that the sample is representative of the entire lot. The cartridges shall be thoroughly mixed before being divided into samples for the various tests.

b. Firing defects. Firing defects and associated acceptance-rejection criteria are specified in Table I.

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CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS

MIL-C-60808A(AR)

PARAGRAPH	TITLE	SHEET	DRAWING NUMBER
4.3.3.1	Cartridge, Caliber .45 Reference	1 OF 2	10522507
			NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY: Not applicable

CATEGORY	EXAMINATION OR TEST	NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS	AQL OR 100%	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION METHOD
	TESTS				
	Bullet extraction	25	1/	3.2	4.4.1
	Residual stress (mercurous nitrate)	20	1/	3.3	4.4.2
	Waterproof	50	2/	3.4	4.4.3
	Velocity 4/	300	3/	3.5	4.4.4
	Chamber pressure 4/	300	3/	3.6	4.4.4
	Function and casualty	300	5/	3.7	4.4.5

NOTES:

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CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS

MIL-C-60808A(AR)

PARAGRAPH	TITLE		SHEET 2 OF 2		DRAWING NUMBER
4.3.3.1	Cartridge, Caliber .45 Reference				10522507
					NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY: Not applicable
CATEGORY	EXAMINATION OR TEST	NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS	AQL OR 100%	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION METHOD
	1/ Failure of two or more cartridges to comply with the applicable requirements shall be cause for rejection of the lot. If one cartridge fails in the first test, a second sample consisting of double the number of cartridges in the first sample shall be tested. If any failing cartridges are found in the second sample, the lot shall be rejected.				
	2/ Failure of ten of more cartridges to comply with the applicable requirement shall be cause for rejection of the lot. If more than three but less than ten cartridges fail in the first test, a second sample consisting of double the number of cartridges in the first sample shall be tested. The lot shall be rejected if, in the combined first and second sample, ten or more cartridges fail to comply with the applicable requirements.				
	3/ Failure of the cartridges to comply with the applicable requirements shall be cause for rejection of the lot.				
	4/ Velocity test and chamber pressure test shall be performed simultaneously.				
	5/ Examination for firing defects shall be made during the firing of all ballistic tests. The lot shall be rejected when firing defects exceed the acceptance number in Table I.				

NOTES:

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TABLE I

Firing defect classification and accept-reject criteria

Defect Class	Defect Description	ACC	REJ
	CARTRIDGE FAILURES		
Critical	a. Bullet in bore	0	1
Critical	b. Misfire - Vent hole missing or blocked 1/	0	1
Major	c. Misfire - (excluding b. above)	1	2
	Primer Failures		
Major	a. Perforation of firing pin indent in primer cup	7	8
Major	b. Escape of gas through primer cup (excluding a. above)	3	4
Major	c. Loose primer 2/	3	4
Major	d. Blown primer 2/	0	1
Major	e. Dropped primer 2/	0	1
	f. Escape or gas around primer cup		
Major	(1) 50% or more than 50% of periphery	10	11
Minor	(2) Less than 50% or periphery	20	21
	Case Casualties 3/		
I. Longitudinal split			
Major	a. Body (J)	7	8
Major	b. Body (K)	1	2
Major	c. to head (L)	0	1

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Major	d. Through head (M)	0	1

II. Circumferential Rupture

Major	a. Partial (J)	3	4
Major	b. Partial, body (K)	0	1
Major	c. Partial, body (L)	0	1
Major	d. Complete	0	1

Note 1/ Each cartridge that misfires shall be disassembled and examined for a blocked or missing vent hole. If the vent hole is blocked or missing the lot shall be rejected.

Note 2/ Primer Defect Description:

a. Loose primer. The fired primer shall be called loose when it protrudes above the case head or movement of the primer can be observed by applying pressure on the primer by means of a probe, thumbnail or fingertip.

b. Blown primer. A primer which, when the cartridge is fired, is separated completely from the head of the cartridge case, and both the head of the case and the primer pocket are such that it is readily detectable with the naked eye.

c. Dropped primer. A primer which falls from the primer pocket after the cartridge is fired.

Note 3/ For location of defects indicated by letters in parenthesis, see Drawing 7643674.

4.3.4 Packaging, packing and marking. During or immediately prior to the packaging operation, 100% examination of the cartridges shall be performed to ascertain that the cartridge type conforms to the drawing. Occurrence of a high pressure test cartridge shall be classed as a critical defect. Occurrence of any type other than high pressure test shall be classed as a major defect. All non-conforming cartridges shall be rejected. Inspection for packaging, packing and marking shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-644 as applicable to the drawing or as required by the contract.

4.3.5 Inspection equipment. the inspection equipment required to perform the examination and test prescribed herein is described in the PARAGRAPH REFERENCE/INSPECTION METHOD column in the tables starting with 4.3.2.1. The contractor shall submit for approval inspection equipment designs in accordance with the terms of the contract. See section 6 of MIL-A-48078 and 6.2 herein.

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4.3.5.1 Inspection equipment list. The examination and tests shall be made using equipment listed on LI-10522507, except as specified in 4.3.

4.4 Methods of inspection.

4.4.1 Bullet extraction. The cartridges shall be tested in an approved bullet extractor machine. The rate of travel of the test head shall be not less than three not more than six inches per minute. The test shall be conducted in accordance with SCATP-.45.

4.4.2 Residual stress (mercurous nitrate). Test shall be in conducted in accordance with SCATP-.45.

4.4.3 Waterproof. The test shall be conducted in accordance with SCATP-.45. The container shall be evacuated to a pressure of 5 pounds per square inch (10 inches of mercury) below atmospheric pressure and held at that pressure. The number of bubbles liberated from the mouth or primer or each cartridge shall be observed.

4.4.4 Velocity and chamber pressure. Prior to testing, cartridges shall be conditioned at 70°F ± 2°F for two hours minimum. Velocity and chamber pressure shall be measured simultaneously. The test shall be conducted in accordance with SCATP-.45 and the following: Five barrel assemblies shall be selected from a quantity of eight assemblies. Prior to the selection of the five barrel assemblies, each of the eight barrel assemblies shall be "broken in" by firing 100 standard cartridges. Selection of the five barrel assemblies shall be made by firing 30 reference cartridges in each barrel assembly. The five test barrel assemblies that have the lowest standard deviation for velocity shall be selected for the test. Twenty cartridges shall be fired in each of the five barrel assemblies. The average velocity and chamber pressure and the standard deviation for velocity and chamber pressure for the five assemblies shall be computed. If the average velocity for any barrel assembly varies from the average for the five assemblies by more than plus or minus 10 feet per second on the first day of firing, then that assembly shall be discarded and another selected. Firing shall be conducted until the aforementioned condition is met by all five assemblies; thereafter on the two succeeding days, the same five assemblies shall be used. An additional twenty cartridges shall be fired in the same manner in the same barrel assemblies on each of the two succeeding days. The average velocity and chamber pressure and the standard deviation of velocity and chamber pressure for each twenty round test, the daily average velocity and chamber pressure (twenty rounds in each of five assemblies) and the grand average for the entire fifteen velocity and chamber pressure series (five assemblies on each of three days) shall be computed.

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4.4.5 Function and casualty. The test shall be conducted simultaneously with all ballistic tests.

4.4.6 Defect penalty. In any ballistic test in which the occurrence of a firing defect prevents the obtaining of a reliable result for the characteristic being tested, an additional shot shall be fired. that particular test shall not be penalized, but the accpetance sample shall be penalized for such defects in accordance with Table I.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packing - Level A (Worldwide shipment). The cartridges shall be packed in accordance with drawing 9396206.

5.2 Marking and labeling. Marking and labeling of the packed cartridge shall be in accordance with drawing 9396206.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The cartridges covered by this specification are intended for use as reference cartridges for calibration purposes in caliber .45 cartridge acceptance testing.

6.2 Ordering data. Ordering data should include:

a. Title, number and date of this specification.

b. Provisions for the submission of inspection equipment designs (see 6.3).

c. Provisions for the submission of the acceptance inspection reports containing final inspection results for each lot of ammunition presented to the Government (see 6.4).

6.3 Submission of inspection equipment designs for approval. (See MIL-A-48078). Submit inspection equipment designs as required to Commander, ARDEC, ATTN: AMSMC-QAF-I(D), Picatinny Arsenal, NJ 07806-5000.

6.4 Submission of test data. In addition to the normal distribution of records, when the cartridge is procured by the US AMCCOM, on (1) copy of all ballistic data and the ammunition data card for each lot shall be forwarded to: Commander, ARDEC, ATTN: AMSMC-QAF-S(D), Picatinny Arsenal, NJ 07806-5000.

6.5 Hazard notice. The cartridge described herein and some of its components are flammable and explosive and consequently present hazards in manufacture, handling, storage and shipment. The contractor should recognize these hazards and take appropriate

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measures to prevent fire, explosion, adverse environment, rough handling, corrosive atmosphere and electrically inducted incidents. Such measures shall include the employment of an effective safety program that addresses the inherent hazards associated with the cartridge.

6.6 Drawings. Drawings listed in Section 2 of this specification under the heading US Army Armament Research, Development and Engineering Center (ARDEC) may also include drawings prepared by, and identified as Edgewood Arsenal, Frankford Arsenal, Rock Island Arsenal, US Army Armament Research and Development Command (ARRADCOM), US Army Armament Research and Development Center (ARDC) or Picatinny Arsenal drawings. Technical data originally prepared by these activities is now under the cognizance of ARDEC.

6.7 In-Process controls.

6.7.1 Uniformity of charge. A machine shall be chosen which is known to drop charges with better than average uniformity and which gives constant results in the daily production tests. If relative machine performance is unknown, special tests should be fired to assure selection of a good machine.

6.7.2 Loading control. A quantity of 20 cartridges shall be fired for velocity and 20 cartridges for pressure each two hours of an eight hour shift to verify uniformity of charge weight and established velocity and pressure values. Results of these production control firings shall be available to the Government upon request. Charge weight and uniformity of charge weight shall be checked every hour. Charge weight, when once established, shall not be changed during production of the entire lot.

6.8 Changes from previous issue. Asterisks are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extensiveness of the changes.

6.9 Subject term (key word) listing.

Ballistic Acceptance
Calibration Ammunition
Caliber .45 Cartridge
Reference Cartridge
Small Arms Ammunition

Custodian:
Army(AR)

Preparing activity:
Army(AR)

(Project 1305-AC55)

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